HL-CYB-001

Focused acceptance criteria and approval gates

Enterprise Zero Trust Security Architecture

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T6 baseline, 2026-11-06. Lab implementation PLANNED; operational tests NOT TESTED; owner user acceptance testing (UAT) PENDING.

Engineering asks whether the approved lab works as specified. Owner UAT asks whether it supports the intended business workflows. Keep these decisions separate. Assignment requirements and its single 100-point rubric govern this four-week baseline; no second rubric is defined here.

1. Measurable completion criteria

All criteria below are mandatory for project engineering completion. Each FAC ID maps to the same-numbered FWR requirement, FSC control and FWT test in the coverage index.

Table 1. Measurable completion criteria

ID	Completion evidence
FAC-01	Hardware readiness/approvals and isolation inspected; lab mock denial demonstrated; no protected-network probes/trust/data/credential reuse.
FAC-02	One operational host/four baseline VMs, Management/Corporate/Restricted, capacity fit, named management/console recovery and actual permitted/default-denied flows.
FAC-03	Separate AD/DNS/Group Policy; three standard users/role groups and one privileged admin; standard logon, all six role cases and app revocation verified.
FAC-04	Supported Windows/Linux baseline, host firewalls, update/antivirus status and standard-user privilege denial verified.
FAC-05	One CA/HTTPS leaf, correct chain/name/date behavior and untrusted-client rejection; trust restricted to lab clients.
FAC-06	Separate lab Tailscale reaches only named APP1 HTTPS; unauthorized/wrong-port and existing/new revoked sessions denied; no broad routes or production enrollment.
FAC-07	Five representative events from two or three relevant sources and one denied-access investigation tied to actual policy.
FAC-08	One useful local operation, safe invalid-input rejection, correct output and repeat execution without unintended changes.
FAC-09	One encrypted off-compute backup successfully restored in isolation; actual recovery time, data/HTTPS/role checks and exclusions recorded.
FAC-10	All ten tests/every mandatory subcheck have evidence and PASS; no unresolved critical/high safety issue; five T7 final submissions and reviewed sanitized GitHub publication exist.

A missing/blocked mandatory subcheck is NOT TESTED, not a pass or an approved omission. No 95% threshold, enterprise RPO/RTO, six-zone requirement, extra provider, two-tier CA, twenty-event target or extended retention calculation applies. Reintroducing enterprise scope requires explicit owner approval and corresponding specification changes before evaluation.

Critical isolation, privilege/authorization, TLS trust, remote exposure, recovery-integrity, secret-disclosure or false-result failures block acceptance regardless of points. Retain original failure evidence and record bounded remediation/retest. Scope changes require a new explicit owner decision; never downgrade an expected denial after seeing a permit.

2. Phase gates and stage approvals

AGENTS.md still requires explicit approval **before every stage A-L**, identifying scope/assets/permitted changes/validation/rollback. The guide groups them into five phases, with stage L's explicitly approved automation/recovery portion before final K validation if needed. A document, PR merge or previous stage does not approve execution.

Table 2. Phase gates and stage approvals

Phase	Required exit evidence
1: Infrastructure and Network	Delivered/inspected compatible assets where needed, data/service inventory, exact disk/backup/recovery approval, isolated host/firewall/three-zone policy and console recovery
2: Identity and Endpoint Security	Directory counts/logon/policy, Windows/Linux host baseline and separate privileges
3: Zero Trust Access Controls	Six app cases/revocation, one CA/leaf trust/expiry, one-resource Tailscale permit/deny/revoke
4: Monitoring, Automation and Recovery	Five events/investigation, one repeatable operation and measured isolated APP1 restore
5: Validation and Final Submission	Every test/subcheck passes, actual evidence/rubric, five T7 files, reviewed publication and separate owner UAT decision

Delivery/compatibility, exact disk/recovery, safe egress and lawful software/provider terms are prerequisites, not results supplied by T6. Existing service migration/shutdown and destructive recovery need their exact owner scope. A temporary isolated APP1 restore copy is justified solely for FAC-09; it adds no permanent baseline VM.

3. Engineering verification record

Record stage/approval/date, versions/asset roles, change, requirement/control/test/FAC IDs, expected and actual result, evidence reference, verifier, second observation, defects/severity, recovery state and verdict. A second tool/log observation is not independent human review. Retain actual operational fields empty until execution; current test verdicts stay NOT TESTED.

T6 engineering completion is narrower: consistent reviewed specifications/PDFs, focused regression and preservation checks, a finalized Markdown-only T6 report, actual CI/merge and local/remote synchronization. It does not require future T7 templates or operational tests to be performed. Historical bootstrap B01-B14 and earlier stage criteria are preserved in previous Git revisions/reports; they are not extra current implementation targets.

4. Owner UAT record

The owner later checks analyst report access, engineer maintenance-page access, unassigned-user denial, remote access/revocation and understandable recovery/evidence records. Record reviewer/date, observed usability, limitations, follow-ups and explicit confirmation reference. **Owner UAT remains PENDING** without that confirmation. Engineering verification, grading, CI and publication cannot supply acceptance.

5. Current gate

The five editable submission templates are available after the owner-authorized consolidation. They supply no operational evidence, stage approval or owner acceptance. Lab implementation remains PLANNED and operational tests NOT TESTED; each stage still requires its own approval. See task reports for repository engineering results; the project final report remains a template.